

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Request for Proposal (RFP)

Birbal Group Payroll & HR Operations System

Clean reconstruction specification

Prepared for

Birbal Group

Document status: ** Clean reconstruction specification

Prepared for: ** Birbal Group

Purpose: ** Recreate the existing payroll and HR operations software from scratch without losing the functionality already established.

Currency and locale: ** Indian Rupees (INR), India locale (`en-IN`)

Source baseline: ** Current Birbal Group payroll application, current UI/API behavior, project overview, employee directory, salary template, and workplace conduct rules.

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Birbal Group requires a web-based payroll and HR operations system for managing employees across multiple restaurant brands and locations.

The system must replace manual spreadsheet-based payroll workflows with a single operational application that supports:

- Central employee master records.
- Brand, location, department, designation, and employment lookup lists.
- Monthly attendance and payroll entry.
- Salary component calculation.
- ESI and PF applicability and deductions.
- Outlet advances, company advances, and other deductions.
- Payment status tracking.
- Payroll summary and location/brand filtering.
- CSV exports.
- Individual salary-slip generation.
- Salary-slip download, printing, and WhatsApp sharing.
- Brand-specific letterhead management.
- Appointment/joining, experience, and termination letter generation.
- Cross-brand employee reference and statutory review.

The application is intended for internal use by Birbal Group administration, HR, payroll, finance, and management users. It must be practical for daily use, easy to operate, auditable, responsive on desktop and tablet screens, and safe for sensitive employee and bank information.

The current system is a centralized payroll management application for Birbal Group restaurant brands and outlets. The existing project overview describes a baseline of:

- 4 brands.
- 8 locations.
- Approximately 41 employee records.
- Approximately ₹6.1 lakh monthly payroll in the overview snapshot.
- A directory snapshot with a stated monthly total of approximately ₹6.32 lakh.

These numbers are reference snapshots only. The rebuilt system must import or enter the current employee and salary data rather than hard-code the snapshot values.

The current application contains the following primary areas:

1. Dashboard
2. Employees
3. Master Employee
4. Payroll Entry
5. Payroll Summary

6. Settings

- Active employees appear in monthly payroll entry.
- Employees marked as **Left** are excluded from new monthly entry but remain visible in historical months where a payroll record already exists.
- Payroll is stored uniquely by employee, month, and year.
- A payroll row can be saved even when the employee has zero days worked.
- A newly displayed employee without a saved monthly record is represented as a pending, unsaved payroll row.
- Payment status is tracked separately from whether payroll data has been entered.

The following points must be confirmed before production sign-off:

1. Letter types: The historical project overview mentions warning letters, while the current employee interface implements:

- Appointment / joining letter.
- Experience certificate.
- Termination letter.

The proposal must price the three currently implemented letter types and list warning-letter generation as an optional clarification item unless Birbal Group confirms it is required.

2. Standard Bonus: The intended salary formula includes Standard Bonus. The rebuild must make Standard Bonus part of the authoritative salary calculation. The current implementation has inconsistent preview/derivation behavior in some employee views, so the rebuilt system must use one server-side formula everywhere.

3. Statutory rates: The current UI displays ESI and PF rates as below. These rates must be configurable or versioned for future legal changes, with the currently required defaults preserved:

- Employee ESI: 0.75% of gross.
- Employer ESI: 3.25% of gross.
- Employee PF: 12% of PF wage, capped at ₹15,000 wage.
- Employer PF: 12% of PF wage, capped at ₹15,000 wage.

4. Payroll period denominator: The current system uses 30 days as the monthly denominator, including for salary component proration. This must be confirmed as the business rule for the rebuild.

The selected vendor or development team must:

1. Recreate the current functional scope from scratch.
2. Preserve the existing payroll calculation intent.
3. Make payroll calculations consistent and server-authoritative.
4. Reduce manual spreadsheet work.
5. Prevent duplicate payroll records for the same employee and month.
6. Make payroll status and pending payments visible at a glance.
7. Support multiple brands and locations without duplicating the application.
8. Protect employee identity, statutory, and bank information.

9. Produce professional, printable documents.
 10. Provide a clean, maintainable codebase and deployment documentation.
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The implementation must include:

- Web application frontend.
- Backend API.
- Relational database.
- Employee CRUD.
- Master employee register.
- Payroll entry and calculation.
- Payroll summary.
- Payment status management.
- Dashboard and aggregate reporting.
- Lookup/settings management.
- Brand letterhead upload and management.
- Salary-slip generation.
- Appointment/joining letter generation.
- Experience certificate generation.
- Termination letter generation.
- CSV export.
- Print support.
- WhatsApp sharing workflow using device/browser capabilities.
- Data validation and error handling.
- Responsive layout.
- Deployment and environment documentation.
- Data import support for existing employee records.

The proposal must separately price or identify:

- Warning letter generation.
- User authentication and role-based permissions.
- Payroll approval or payroll locking.
- Attendance import from an external attendance device.
- Bank payment file generation.
- Direct WhatsApp Business API sending.
- Email delivery of salary slips.
- Automated statutory filing.
- Employee self-service portal.
- Leave management.
- Advances ledger and recovery schedule.

- Historical audit log.

Unless explicitly approved, these items are not part of the minimum reconstruction.

- Direct salary disbursement through a bank.
 - Tax filing submission.
 - Legal or statutory compliance advice.
 - Biometric attendance hardware integration.
 - Full accounting/ERP replacement.
 - Employee self-service login.
 - Native Android/iOS apps.
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The current interface presents a single internal administrative user persona:

- **Admin / HR User**
- Maintains employee records.
- Enters and updates monthly payroll.
- Reviews payroll summaries.
- Changes payment statuses.
- Generates documents.
- Maintains lookup values and letterheads.

The vendor should support role separation, even if the first deployment uses one admin account:

- Manage all settings.
- Manage users and access.
- Create, edit, and delete employees.
- Manage payroll.
- Manage letterheads.
- View and export all data.
- Manage employee master records.
- Generate HR letters.
- View payroll and master employee information.
- No access to system user administration unless granted.
- Enter payroll.
- Review salary calculations.
- Update payment status.

- Export payroll data.
- View bank details if authorized.

- View dashboard and payroll summary.
- Filter and export permitted reports.
- Cannot edit employees, payroll, settings, or letterheads.

If roles are not implemented in the first phase, the system must still be structured so they can be added without a rewrite.

The application must provide:

- Persistent navigation to all core modules.
- Clear active-page indication.
- Desktop sidebar navigation.
- Mobile/tablet navigation that remains usable on narrow screens.
- Birbal Group branding and Payroll System identification.
- Responsive content area.
- Loading, empty, success, and error states.
- Toast or inline confirmation after save, update, delete, and status changes.
- Confirmation before destructive deletion.
- No silent failure when an API or database operation fails.

Required navigation labels:

- Dashboard
 - Employees
 - Master Employee
 - Payroll Entry
 - Payroll Summary
 - Settings
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Provide a monthly operational snapshot for management and payroll users.

- Month selector.
- Year selector.
- Brand filter.
- Location filter.
- Payment-status filter:

- All statuses.
- Paid.
- Not Paid.
- On Hold.

For the selected month, year, and filters, show:

- Total paid amount.
- Total pending amount.
- Number of paid employees.
- Number of pending employees.
- Employee count.
- Total payroll / total net salary.
- Total advances.
- Number of processed payroll rows.
- Number of pending payroll rows.

The dashboard must show employee payroll status with:

- Location grouping.
- Employee name.
- Brand.
- Processed or pending indicator.
- Days worked.
- Gross salary.
- Final/net salary.
- Payment status.
- ESI applicability.
- PF applicability.

For each location group, show:

- Employee count.
- Location gross subtotal.
- Location net subtotal.

Provide a downloadable CSV report for the selected month and filters.

The CSV must include, at minimum:

- Location.
- Employee.
- Brand.
- Days worked.
- Gross salary.
- Outlet advance.

- Company advance.
- Total advances.
- ESI.
- PF.
- Net salary.
- Payment status.

The export must escape commas, quotes, and line breaks safely.

Provide the primary employee master record management screen.

- List all employees.
 - Search by:
 - Employee name.
 - Employee ID/code.
 - Brand.
 - Location.
 - Department.
 - Designation.
 - Filter by brand.
 - Filter by location.
 - Show dependent location options when a brand is selected.
 - Show active/left status.
 - Sort in a predictable manner, preferably by employee name.
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- Employee ID/code.
 - Employee name.
 - Phone.
 - Department.
 - Designation.
 - Brand.
 - Location.
 - Employment status.
 - Gross or monthly salary.
 - Actions.
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- Edit employee.
 - Delete employee.
 - Generate HR letter.

Deletion must require confirmation. The system must explain the impact of deleting an employee and must protect historical payroll data according to the approved retention policy. Preferred production behavior is to use inactive/left status instead of deleting records that have payroll history.

The form must be organized into the following sections:

1. Basic Info.
2. Work Details.
3. Salary Structure.
4. Statutory Details.
5. Bank Details.

The form must support both create and edit modes.

Employee ID/code	Text	No	If blank, display/generated fallback such as EMP-{id}
Full name	Text	Yes	Employee legal/display name
Phone	Text	No	Indian phone number format should be accepted
Email	Email	No	Validate format when supplied
Address	Multiline text	No	Full employee address

Brand name	Lookup/select	Yes	Brand or outlet group
Location	Lookup/select	Yes	Branch/outlet location
Department	Lookup/select or text	No	Configurable lookup
Designation	Lookup/select or text	No	Configurable lookup
Joining date	Date	No	Used in HR documents
Employment type	Lookup/select	No	Example: Full-time
Status	Select	Yes	At minimum Active and Left

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Basic salary	Currency	No	Monthly component
HRA	Currency	No	Monthly component
Other allowance	Currency	No	Monthly component
Standard bonus	Currency	No	Monthly component; included in authoritative formula
Per-day salary	Currency	Derived/legacy	Fallback when components are not supplied

The UI should display:

- Monthly component total.
- Effective per-day rate.
- Salary calculation explanation.
- Clear indication of whether the rate is component-derived or legacy per-day.

ESI applicable	Boolean	Yes/default true	Employee-level toggle
PF applicable	Boolean	Yes/default true	Employee-level toggle
PAN	Text	No	Sensitive data
Aadhaar	Text	No	Sensitive data; mask in list views
PF UAN	Text	No	Statutory identifier
ESI number	Text	No	Statutory identifier

Bank name	Text	No	
Account name	Text	No	
Account number	Text	No	Mask except when authorized
IFSC	Text	No	Validate basic IFSC pattern
UPI	Text	No	Optional alternate payment reference

- Name, brand, and location are mandatory.

- Currency fields must be numeric and non-negative.
 - Days and deduction values must be non-negative.
 - Email must be valid when entered.
 - Status values must be controlled.
 - Duplicate lookup values must be prevented case-insensitively.
 - Sensitive fields must not be exposed unnecessarily in list views or exports.
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Provide a cross-brand, cross-location employee register for HR reference and statutory review.

- Search by name, designation, department, brand, or location.
- Brand filter.
- Location filter.
- Print action.

- Serial number.
- Employee ID/code.
- Employee name.
- Designation.
- Department.
- Brand.
- Location.
- Per-day salary.
- Gross/monthly salary.
- ESI applicability.
- Employee ESI.
- Employer ESI.
- PF applicability.
- Employee PF.
- Employer PF.
- Net monthly salary after employee ESI and PF.

Display the currently configured statutory assumptions:

- Employee ESI: 0.75%.
- Employer ESI: 3.25%.
- Employee PF: 12% up to ₹15,000 PF wage.
- Employer PF: 12% up to ₹15,000 PF wage.

The values should come from a configurable/versioned rule source in a production implementation, not be duplicated in multiple UI components.

- ESI Yes/No toggle per employee.
 - PF Yes/No toggle per employee.
 - Save immediately with success/error feedback.
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Enter and save monthly attendance, advances, deductions, and notes for active employees.

- Month selector.
- Year selector.
- Brand filter.
- Location filter.

The month and year should default to the current payroll period according to the business calendar. The current system uses the previous month when the calendar month is January; this behavior must be confirmed or replaced with a clearly defined payroll-period rule.

- Include active employees.
- Exclude left employees from new payroll entry.
- Preserve access to existing historical payroll records for left employees.

- Employee name.
- Brand.
- Location.
- Days worked.
- Per-day salary.
- Gross salary.
- Outlet advance.
- Company advance.
- Other deduction.
- ESI toggle and amount.
- PF toggle and amount.
- Final salary.
- Notes.
- Save action.

- Days worked.
- Outlet advance.
- Company advance.
- Other deduction.

- ESI enabled/disabled for this payroll row.
 - PF enabled/disabled for this payroll row.
 - Notes.
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- Unsaved changes must be visually identifiable.
 - Save must be available per employee row.
 - Saving must create a record if none exists.
 - Saving again must update the same employee/month/year record.
 - The save action must not create duplicates.
 - After a successful save, the row must indicate that it is saved.
 - After a failure, preserve the user's entered values and show an actionable error.
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- Days worked: minimum 0, maximum 60, supports half-day increments.
 - Deductions: minimum 0.
 - Month: 1–12.
 - Year: 2000–2100, or the approved operational range.
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Provide a finalized, reviewable monthly payroll view with payment tracking and salary-slip actions.

- Month selector.
 - Year selector.
 - Brand filter.
 - Location filter.
 - Payment-status filter.
 - Export CSV action.
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- Total gross.
 - Total deductions.
 - Total net payout.
 - Number of employees in the filtered result.
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- Employee name.
 - Brand.
 - Location.
 - Payment status.
 - Bank account number, subject to permissions/masking.
 - Days worked.

- Per-day salary.
- Gross salary.
- Outlet advance.
- Company advance.
- Other deduction.
- ESI.
- PF.
- Final/net salary.
- Notes.
- Salary-slip action.

Each saved payroll row must support:

- Paid.
- Not Paid.
- Hold / On Hold.

Changing the status must save immediately and refresh the displayed totals/status.

Each payroll row must provide a salary-slip preview with:

- Employee identity.
- Employee code.
- Designation and department.
- Date of joining, when available.
- PAN, when authorized and available.
- Brand and location.
- Payroll month/year.
- Days worked out of 30.
- Earnings.
- Deductions.
- Gross salary.
- Total deductions.
- Net salary payable.
- Notes, when present.
- Generated date.
- Computer-generated document disclaimer.

The salary slip must support:

- Download as A4 PDF.
- Print.
- WhatsApp sharing or a browser/device share flow.
- Brand-specific letterhead background when configured.

When a brand letterhead is configured:

- Use the letterhead as the full-page A4 background.
- Place the salary-slip content in the approved content area.
- Preserve the letterhead's aspect ratio and print quality.

When no letterhead is configured:

- Generate a professional standalone salary-slip PDF.
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Generate professional, printable HR documents from employee data.

Must include:

- Date of issue.
- Employee name.
- Designation.
- Department, when available.
- Brand.
- Location.
- Date of joining.
- Monthly compensation.
- Three-month probation statement.
- Welcome/appointment language.
- Workplace Conduct & Discipline terms.
- HR/company sign-off.
- Employee acknowledgement.
- Signature and date placeholders.

Must include:

- Date of issue.
- "To Whom It May Concern" heading.
- Employee name.
- Brand.
- Designation.
- Department, when available.
- Location.
- Joining date.
- Last working date.
- Calculated tenure where dates are available.
- Statement of satisfactory service.
- Company/HR sign-off.

Must include:

- Date of issue.
- Employee name.
- Designation and department.
- Brand and location.
- Effective last working/termination date.
- Employment period where available.
- Exit formalities.
- Company-property handover requirement.
- Full and final settlement statement.
- Company/HR sign-off.

The project overview references warning-letter generation, but the current interface does not contain it. If confirmed, the warning-letter module must support:

- Warning reason/category.
 - Incident date.
 - Description of issue.
 - Required corrective action.
 - Consequence of recurrence.
 - Employee acknowledgement.
 - HR/company sign-off.
 - PDF download and print.
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- Preview before download.
 - A4 document proportion.
 - Date inputs for joining and last working dates.
 - Automatic date formatting using Indian locale.
 - Safe file names.
 - Multi-page PDF support.
 - No accidental clipping of conduct rules or signature sections.

The appointment/joining letter must include the following 18 rules, subject to Birbal Group's legal/HR approval:

1. Consumption of alcohol, smoking, gutka, or intoxicating substances during working hours or on company premises is prohibited.
2. Dress code, grooming standards, and uniform, where applicable, must be followed during duty.
3. Employees must maintain hygiene, cleanliness, and a well-groomed appearance.
4. Leave must be informed and approved in advance. Uninformed or unauthorized leave results in double deduction: two days' salary for each day of absence.

5. Misbehavior, indiscipline, or misconduct may result in penalties, fines, suspension, or termination.
6. Physical fights, threats, or violence may result in immediate termination and police/legal action.
7. Employees must maintain a respectful and professional environment.
8. Employees must report on time for the assigned shift.
9. Mobile phone use during working hours is restricted except for work or emergencies with approval.
10. Cash/billing employees are responsible for accuracy; verified shortages may be recovered.
11. Negligent damage to company property may result in recovery after review.
12. Food handling standards must be followed; intentional wastage, misuse, or unauthorized consumption is prohibited.
13. Conflicting outside employment or business requires prior approval.
14. The company may transfer employees to another outlet, department, or role based on business needs.
15. Company information, recipes, pricing, supplier details, and internal processes must not be disclosed externally.
16. Break timings must be followed; unnecessary absence from the work area is not allowed.
17. Safety, hygiene, and operational guidelines must be followed.
18. Customer complaints relating to behavior, service, or negligence may lead to disciplinary action.

These statements should be editable through an approved content/template process in the long term. They must not be treated as legal advice; Birbal Group must approve the final wording.

Allow administrators to maintain dropdown values without code changes.

- Brand Names.
 - Locations.
 - Departments.
 - Designations.
 - Employment Types.
-
- Add value.
 - Rename value.
 - Delete value.
 - Prevent duplicate values case-insensitively.
 - Show usage count per value.
 - Warn before deleting a value used by employees.
 - Preserve existing employee records when a lookup value is deleted.
 - Remove deleted values from future dropdown options.

For each brand, administrators must be able to:

- Upload a letterhead image.

- Replace an existing letterhead.
- Remove a letterhead.
- See whether a letterhead is configured.

Accepted formats:

- PNG.
- JPEG/JPG.
- WebP if supported by the PDF rendering pipeline.

Maximum upload size in the current baseline: 2 MB.

Recommended letterhead design target:

- Full A4 background.
- Approximately 794 × 1123 pixels for screen-created assets.

All calculations must be performed by a single authoritative calculation service on the backend. The frontend may preview values but must not be the only source of truth.

The salary components are:

- Basic Salary.
- HRA.
- Other Allowance.
- Standard Bonus.

$$\text{Monthly Component Total} = \text{Basic Salary} + \text{HRA} + \text{Other Allowance} + \text{Standard Bonus}$$

If any monthly salary component is present:

$$\text{Effective Per-Day Salary} = \text{Monthly Component Total} / 30$$

If no monthly salary component is supplied:

$$\text{Effective Per-Day Salary} = \text{Legacy Per-Day Salary}$$

$$\text{Gross Salary} = \text{Effective Per-Day Salary} \times \text{Days Worked}$$

If ESI is applicable:

$$\text{Employee ESI} = \text{Gross Salary} \times 0.75\%$$

If ESI is not applicable:

$$\text{Employee ESI} = 0$$

Round to two decimal places using the approved rounding policy.

For statutory/reference reporting:

$$\text{Employer ESI} = \text{Gross Salary} \times 3.25\%$$

This is not deducted from the employee's net salary.

If PF is applicable:

$$\text{PF Wage} = \text{minimum}(\text{Gross Salary}, ₹15,000) \text{ Employee PF} = \text{PF Wage} \times 12\%$$

If PF is not applicable:

$$\text{Employee PF} = 0$$

For statutory/reference reporting:

$$\text{Employer PF} = \text{PF Wage} \times 12\%$$

This is not deducted from the employee's net salary.

The monthly payroll-entry deductions are:

- Outlet Advance.
- Company Advance.
- Other Deduction.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Final Salary} = & \text{Gross Salary} - \text{Outlet Advance} - \text{Company Advance} - \text{Other Deduction} - \\ & \text{Employee ESI} - \text{Employee PF} \end{aligned}$$

- Do not allow negative deductions.
- Do not calculate different totals in different screens.
- Store the calculated gross, statutory deductions, and final salary on the payroll record for historical reproducibility.
- Store the applied rule/rate version or calculation metadata in a production-grade implementation.
- Display a calculation breakdown wherever the user needs to validate a number.
- Confirm the rounding rule, especially for component proration and statutory deductions.

The following relational model is required at minimum.

id	Primary key
employee_code	Optional human-readable employee ID

brand_name	Brand/company/outlet group
location	Branch/outlet
name	Employee name
phone	Phone number
email	Email
address	Address
department	Department
designation	Job title
joining_date	Date of joining
employment_type	Employment classification
status	Active/Left or approved status list
basic_salary	Monthly basic
hra	Monthly HRA
other_allowance	Monthly allowance
standard_bonus	Monthly standard bonus
per_day_salary	Legacy/fallback rate or derived effective rate
esi_applicable	Employee ESI flag
pf_applicable	Employee PF flag
pan	PAN
aadhaar	Aadhaar
pf_uan	PF UAN
esi_number	ESI number
bank_name	Bank name
account_name	Account holder name
account_number	Bank account number
ifsc	IFSC
upi	UPI reference
created_at	Creation timestamp
updated_at	Recommended update timestamp

id	Primary key

employee_id	Foreign key to employees
month	Payroll month, 1–12
year	Payroll year
days_worked	Decimal, supports half-days
gross_salary	Calculated gross
outlet_advance	Monthly deduction
company_advance	Monthly deduction
other_deduction	Monthly deduction
esi	Employee ESI deduction
pf	Employee PF deduction
final_salary	Calculated net salary
notes	Optional payroll note
payment_status	paid, not_paid, hold
created_at	Creation timestamp
updated_at	Update timestamp
calculation_version	Recommended

Required unique constraint:

```
unique(employee_id, month, year)
```

id	Primary key
type	Lookup group
value	Lookup value
created_at	Creation timestamp

Recommended unique constraint:

```
unique(type, normalized_value)
```

brand_name	Primary key or foreign key to brand
image_data or object-storage key	Letterhead asset
mime_type	PNG/JPEG/WebP

updated_at	Last update timestamp
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For production, object storage is preferred over storing large base64 image data directly in a relational table.

- Users.
 - Roles and permissions.
 - Audit log.
 - Payroll period/lock table.
 - Statutory rule versions.
 - Document template/content versions.
 - Advance ledger.
 - Employee status history.
 - Import batch and import error tables.
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The rebuild may use REST or another documented service architecture, but it must provide equivalent, validated operations.

- GET /api/healthz
- GET /api/employees
- POST /api/employees
- GET /api/employees/{id}
- PATCH /api/employees/{id}
- DELETE /api/employees/{id}

The list response should include the employee's calculated or effective salary information needed by the UI.

- GET /api/payroll?month={month}&year={year}
- POST /api/payroll/upsert
- PATCH /api/payroll/{id}/status

The monthly payroll endpoint must:

- Return saved rows.
- Return unsaved zero-value rows for eligible active employees so the entry screen can be completed.
- Preserve saved historical rows for left employees.
- Return employee name, brand, location, effective rate, all payroll values, notes, and payment status.

- GET /api/settings
- POST /api/settings
- PATCH /api/settings/{id}

- DELETE /api/settings/{id}

Supported setting types:

- brand_name
- location
- department
- designation
- employment_type

- GET /api/letterheads
- GET /api/letterheads/{brandName}
- PUT /api/letterheads/{brandName}
- DELETE /api/letterheads/{brandName}

- Validate all request bodies and query parameters.
 - Return useful error messages.
 - Use consistent status codes.
 - Do not trust client-provided gross/final salary without server recalculation or validation.
 - Enforce employee/month/year uniqueness at the database level.
 - Prevent unauthorized access to sensitive data.
 - Log server errors without logging secrets or full bank/Aadhaar values.
 - Provide API documentation or an OpenAPI specification.
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The rebuild must support initial migration from the current project data.

Potential sources include:

- Existing database records.
- Employee directory PDF/DOCX.
- Salary spreadsheet/template.
- Manually reviewed CSV.
- Provide a documented employee import template.
- Map brand and location values.
- Map employee names and designations.
- Map monthly salary or salary components.
- Map active/left status.
- Preserve employee codes when present.
- Support statutory and bank fields where available.
- Validate duplicates.
- Produce row-level import errors.

- Provide a preview before committing.
- Record import date and source.

The vendor must provide a reconciliation report showing:

- Number of imported employees.
- Employees missing required fields.
- Duplicate or near-duplicate names.
- Missing brand/location values.
- Salary totals before and after import.
- Active versus left counts.
- Records requiring manual review.

No sensitive data should be sent to third parties during migration without written approval.

Exports must:

- Use UTF-8.
- Include a header row.
- Escape CSV values correctly.
- Use Indian salary values with two decimal places where appropriate.
- Include the selected period in the filename.
- Reflect the active filters.

PDFs must:

- Use A4 page size.
- Render Indian Rupee values correctly.
- Support multiple pages.
- Avoid clipping or overlapping text.
- Work with and without a brand letterhead.
- Use deterministic document content from saved data.
- Use safe, readable file names.

Print views must:

- Hide application navigation and controls.
- Preserve table readability.
- Use appropriate page margins.
- Repeat table headers where possible.
- Preserve color distinctions when printing in color.

Minimum requirement:

- Generate the PDF.
- Use device/browser share when supported.
- Open WhatsApp Web or the WhatsApp share destination as a fallback.
- Preselect the employee phone number when available, subject to browser/device limitations.
- Never claim that a message was delivered unless a supported API confirms delivery.

Direct WhatsApp Business API messaging is optional and must be separately scoped.

The interface should feel like a dependable internal operations product: clear, fast, professional, and easy to scan during payroll work.

Required qualities:

- Strong visual hierarchy.
- Clear distinction between editable and calculated values.
- Clear paid, pending, and hold states.
- Searchable and filterable tables.
- Horizontal scrolling for wide payroll tables without losing employee/action context.
- Sticky table headers where appropriate.
- Sticky first/action columns where helpful.
- Responsive mobile navigation.
- Keyboard-friendly form operation.
- Accessible labels and focus states.
- Visible loading and empty states.
- Confirmation for destructive operations.
- No emoji-based UI controls.
- No reliance on color alone to communicate status.

Visual styling may be recreated from the existing product, but the implementation must prioritize readability and operational efficiency over decorative effects.

Employee data includes personally identifiable information, statutory identifiers, and bank details. The solution must include:

- Authentication for all non-public application routes.
- Role-based authorization if multiple roles are enabled.
- HTTPS in production.
- Secure session or token handling.
- Secure password handling if local credentials are used; do not store plaintext passwords.
- Server-side authorization checks.
- Input validation and output encoding.
- Protection against SQL injection.

- CSRF protection appropriate to the chosen authentication/session design.
- Rate limiting on authentication and sensitive endpoints.
- Secrets stored in environment/secrets management, never in source code.
- Masked PAN, Aadhaar, and bank account values in list screens unless authorized.
- Restricted access to exports and salary slips.
- Audit trail for employee edits, payroll edits, status changes, and deletions.
- Backup and restore procedure.
- Retention and deletion policy approved by Birbal Group.
- No sensitive values in application logs.

If authentication is not part of phase one, the proposal must explicitly state that limitation and the risk it creates.

- Application should be suitable for daily business operations.
- Database backups must be configured.
- Recovery steps must be documented.
- Dashboard and standard lists should load promptly for the current scale and remain usable as the employee count grows.
- Search and filters should respond without requiring a full page reload.
- Payroll save should provide immediate feedback.
- PDF generation should show progress for larger documents.

The system should support at least:

- 10 brands.
- 50 locations.
- 1,000 employees.
- 10 years of monthly payroll history.

The vendor should state the tested limits.

Support current versions of:

- Chrome.
- Edge.
- Firefox.
- Safari where applicable.
- Modular frontend and backend.
- Documented database schema.

- Documented API.
- Reproducible local development setup.
- Environment configuration documentation.
- Automated type/build checks.
- Clear error logging.

- Keyboard navigation.
- Visible focus states.
- Form labels.
- Sufficient contrast.
- Accessible dialogs and dropdowns.
- Screen-reader-friendly status text.

The vendor may propose alternatives, but the solution should include:

- Responsive web frontend.
- Backend service with validated API.
- PostgreSQL or equivalent relational database.
- Database-level constraints for payroll uniqueness.
- Server-side calculation service.
- PDF rendering service or reliable browser/PDF library.
- Secure object storage for letterhead assets.
- Authentication and authorization layer.
- Backup and monitoring.

The architecture must avoid:

- Client-only payroll calculations as the source of truth.
 - Unvalidated direct database writes.
 - Hard-coded brands, locations, departments, or designations.
 - Hard-coded statutory rates scattered across screens.
 - Permanent dependence on a spreadsheet for ordinary monthly processing.
-

The selected vendor must deliver:

1. Complete source code.
2. Frontend application.
3. Backend/API application.
4. Database schema and migration scripts.
5. API documentation.
6. Employee and payroll import template.
7. Data migration/reconciliation report.
8. Configurable lookup management.

9. Salary calculation documentation.
 10. PDF salary-slip templates.
 11. HR letter templates.
 12. Letterhead upload and management.
 13. CSV export functionality.
 14. Automated checks or test suite.
 15. Deployment configuration.
 16. Backup and restore instructions.
 17. Administrator user guide.
 18. Payroll operator user guide.
 19. Technical handover documentation.
 20. Source-code and infrastructure ownership transfer.
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The rebuild will be accepted only when all of the following are demonstrated with test data.

- Admin can create an employee with all five form sections.
 - Required validation prevents incomplete employee creation.
 - Admin can edit every employee field.
 - Search and brand/location filters work together.
 - Employee status can be changed from Active to Left.
 - Deletion requires confirmation and follows the approved historical-data policy.
-
- Component-based salary uses Basic + HRA + Other Allowance + Standard Bonus.
 - Component total is divided by 30 for the effective daily rate.
 - Legacy per-day salary is used only when components are absent.
 - Gross equals daily rate multiplied by days worked.
 - ESI and PF calculations match the approved rates and caps.
 - Final salary equals gross minus all employee deductions.
 - The same result appears in Payroll Entry, Payroll Summary, Dashboard, Master Employee, and salary slip.
-
- Active employees appear for the selected month/year.
 - Left employees do not appear as new entry rows.
 - Historical left-employee records remain accessible.
 - User can enter half-days.
 - User can enter each deduction type.
 - User can enable or disable ESI and PF.
 - User can add notes.
 - Save creates one record.
 - Saving again updates the same record.

- No duplicate payroll record is possible for the same employee/month/year.

- Saved rows appear for the selected period.
- Filters work by brand, location, and payment status.
- Paid, Not Paid, and Hold status changes persist.
- Gross, deductions, and net totals update correctly.
- Bank details follow approved masking/permission rules.

- Paid and pending totals match Payroll Summary.
- Advance totals match payroll data.
- Location subtotals reconcile with overall totals.
- CSV export includes the selected filters and period.

- Salary slip displays correct employee and payroll values.
- Salary slip downloads as readable A4 PDF.
- Salary slip prints correctly.
- Salary slip uses the configured brand letterhead.
- Salary slip works without a letterhead.
- WhatsApp/browser-share flow does not corrupt the PDF.
- Joining, experience, and termination letters use current employee data.
- Dates and tenure are formatted correctly.
- Conduct rules appear completely and do not clip across pages.

- Admin can add, rename, and delete lookup values.
- Duplicate lookup values are rejected.
- Usage counts are shown.
- Deleting an in-use lookup displays a warning.
- Brand letterhead can be uploaded, replaced, previewed/used, and removed.

- Unauthorized users cannot access restricted routes.
- Sensitive fields are not exposed in unauthorized views.
- Errors are visible and actionable.
- Database backup and restore steps are documented.

The proposal must include testing for:

- Unit tests for salary calculations.
- API validation tests.
- Employee CRUD tests.

- Payroll upsert and uniqueness tests.
- Payment-status tests.
- Filter and aggregation tests.
- PDF generation tests.
- Letterhead tests.
- Import validation tests.
- Permission tests if authentication is included.
- Responsive layout checks.
- Browser compatibility checks.

Required calculation test cases:

1. Legacy per-day salary with no components.
 2. Basic salary only.
 3. Basic + HRA.
 4. All components including Standard Bonus.
 5. Zero days worked.
 6. Half-day values.
 7. ESI enabled/disabled.
 8. PF enabled/disabled.
 9. PF wage above ₹15,000.
 10. Multiple deductions.
 11. Deduction total greater than gross, with approved handling.
 12. Rounding at fractional paise boundaries.
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- Confirm letter types.
 - Confirm payroll period and denominator.
 - Confirm statutory rates and rounding.
 - Confirm user roles.
 - Confirm deletion/retention policy.
 - Confirm source data and import format.
 - Approve document templates.
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- Set up application architecture.
 - Set up authentication/authorization if approved.
 - Set up database and migrations.
 - Implement shared calculation service.
 - Implement settings and lookup foundation.
-
- Employees list.
 - Add/edit form.

- Master Employee register.
- Search and filtering.
- Employee status.

- Payroll Entry.
- Monthly upsert.
- Payroll Summary.
- Payment status.
- Dashboard aggregates.
- CSV exports.

- Salary slip.
- PDF and print.
- WhatsApp/browser sharing.
- Letterheads.
- HR letters.

- Import current data.
- Reconcile counts and salary totals.
- Run acceptance test scenarios.
- Train users.
- Complete handover.

Each proposal should include:

1. Company/vendor profile.
2. Understanding of the Birbal Group requirements.
3. Proposed architecture.
4. Detailed feature mapping against this RFP.
5. Items included in the base quote.
6. Optional items and separate pricing.
7. Implementation timeline by phase.
8. Team composition and responsibilities.
9. Relevant payroll/HR project experience.
10. Data migration approach.
11. Security approach.
12. Testing and quality approach.
13. Hosting and operating-cost assumptions.
14. Support and maintenance terms.
15. Warranty/bug-fix period.

16. Training and documentation plan.
 17. Ownership and source-code handover terms.
 18. Assumptions, exclusions, and dependencies.
 19. Commercial proposal.
 20. Validity period of the quotation.
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Birbal Group should confirm the following before development begins:

1. Is warning-letter generation required in addition to joining, experience, and termination letters?
 2. Is the monthly calculation denominator always 30 days?
 3. Are statutory rates fixed, or should administrators be able to change them by effective date?
 4. What rounding method should be used: standard half-up, banker's rounding, or another policy?
 5. What should happen when deductions exceed gross salary?
 6. Should employees be soft-deactivated rather than deleted?
 7. Which roles need access to PAN, Aadhaar, PF UAN, ESI, and bank account details?
 8. Is login required for the first release?
 9. Should payroll be lockable after approval/payment?
 10. Should the system support multiple legal entities or only brand/location grouping?
 11. Is direct WhatsApp API sending required, or is browser/device sharing sufficient?
 12. Are salary slips sent to employees by WhatsApp, email, or only downloaded manually?
 13. Are employer ESI/PF values for reporting only, or is an employer-cost report required?
 14. Which employee records are authoritative when the PDF, DOCX, spreadsheet, and database disagree?
 15. What are the backup retention and employee-data retention requirements?
 16. Which letterhead layout and document wording are legally approved?
 17. Should Standard Bonus be prorated by days worked in every document and report?
 18. What is the approved payroll year range and payroll-period cutoff?
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The recreated Birbal Group Payroll & HR Operations System is complete when:

- The approved employee data has been migrated and reconciled.
- All core modules are available.
- Calculations are consistent across every screen and document.
- Payroll records are unique by employee/month/year.
- Payment statuses persist correctly.
- Reports export accurately.
- Salary slips and HR letters render correctly.
- Letterheads work per brand.
- Approved users can operate the system without developer assistance.
- Security, backup, deployment, and handover documentation is complete.
- All acceptance criteria in this RFP have passed.